JLPT *Spin*

Your free *JLPT* study schedule

N5 → N3

A simple week-by-week plan for busy learners. 45 minutes a day, every day, with speaking built in from day one — because the exam tests reading and listening, but real life tests speaking.

The daily 45-minute routine

15 min	Vocabulary & kanji — new words + review in a flashcard app (Anki is free)
15 min	Grammar — learn 1–2 points, write 3 example sentences about *your* life
10 min	Listening — easy audio, podcasts or news, at your level
5 min	Speaking — spin a word at **jlptspin.com** and talk for 1 minute. Mistakes welcome.

N5 · 12 WEEKS

N5 — your first JLPT

Goal: read hiragana & katakana fluently, know basic everyday words and polite sentence patterns.

~800	~100	~80	45 min
words	kanji	grammar points	per day

Week	Focus	Vocab / kanji	Grammar	Speaking (JLPT Spin)
1	Hiragana	All 46 + dakuten	です / じゃないです	Read every spin word aloud
2	Katakana	All 46 + long vowels	これ・それ・あれ、の	Self-introduction (じこしょうかい)
3	Numbers, time, dates	60 words · 10 kanji	～時 / ～曜日 / から・まで	Talk about your daily schedule
4	Verbs (ます-form)	60 words · 10 kanji	ます / ません / ました	What did you do yesterday?
5	Particles	70 words · 10 kanji	は・が・を・に・で・へ・と	Spin N5 words, 1 min each
6	Adjectives	70 words · 10 kanji	い / な adjectives, past	Describe your town / room
7	Existence & place	70 words · 10 kanji	あります / います、～の上	Describe your house
8	て-form	70 words · 10 kanji	～てください / ～ています	What are you doing now?
9	Wants & invitations	70 words · 10 kanji	～たい / ～ませんか / ～ましょう	Your dream weekend
10	Plain form, comparisons	70 words · 10 kanji	～より / ～のほうが / いちばん	Compare two places or foods
11	Review + mock test 1	Review all	Weak points only	Spin random N5, 3 min timer
12	Mock test 2 + timing	Review mistakes	Exam question types	Daily 1 min — keep the habit

N5 tips

- Don't wait to "finish" kana before speaking — say every new word out loud from week 1.
- Do the official sample questions at **jlpt.jp** in week 11 so the format isn't a surprise.
- Listening is where most people lose points. 10 minutes a day is enough if you never skip it.

N4 · 16 WEEKS

N4 — talk about your life

Goal: understand everyday conversations at a natural-ish speed and read simple texts with basic kanji.

~1,500	~300	~130	45–60
words (total)	kanji (total)	new grammar points	min per day

Weeks	Focus	Vocab / kanji per week	Grammar	Speaking (JLPT Spin)
1–2	Plain forms fully	60 words · 15 kanji	dictionary / ない / た forms	Talk casually to yourself (タメ口)
3–4	Potential & experience	60 words · 15 kanji	～られる / ～たことがある	Things you can / have done
5–6	Giving & receiving	60 words · 15 kanji	あげる・くれる・もらう	Best gift you ever got
7–8	Conditionals	60 words · 15 kanji	～たら / ～ば / ～と / ～なら	"If I had a week off..."
9–10	Intentions & plans	60 words · 15 kanji	～つもり / ～(よ)う / ～予定	Spin N4 topics: 旅行, 将来, 夢
11–12	Passive & causative	60 words · 15 kanji	～られる / ～させる	A time someone made you do something
13–14	Keigo basics, reading	Review + short texts	お～になる / お～する	Polite self-intro for a job / school
15–16	Mock tests + weak points	Review mistakes	Exam question types	Spin random N4, 3 min timer

N4 tips

- Conditionals (たら・ば・と・なら) appear every exam. Make your own example for each and say it out loud.
- Start reading one short easy-Japanese news article a day (NHK NEWS WEB EASY has furigana).
- When you spin a word, use at least one grammar point from this week in your 1-minute answer.

N3 · 20 WEEKS

N3 — the big jump

Goal: read articles on familiar topics, follow conversations at near-natural speed, give opinions and reasons.

~3,700	~650	~150	60
words (total)	kanji (total)	new grammar points	min per day

Weeks	Focus	Vocab / kanji per week	Grammar	Speaking (JLPT Spin)
1–3	Reasons & explanations	100 words · 18 kanji	～ため / ～おかげで / ～せいで	Why are you learning Japanese?
4–6	Hearsay & appearance	100 words · 18 kanji	～らしい / ～ようだ / ～っぽい	Talk about a rumour or trend (流行)
7–9	Change & time	100 words · 18 kanji	～ようになる / ～うちに / ～最中	How your life changed this year
10–12	Opinions	100 words · 18 kanji	～べきだ / ～わけではない / ～に対して	Spin N3: 環境, 人生, 自信 — agree or disagree
13–15	Formal & written style	100 words · 18 kanji	～による / ～について / である	Explain a custom from your country
16–17	Reading speed	Review + 1 article/day	Long-text question types	Summarise today's article in 1 min
18–20	Mock tests + weak points	Review mistakes	Timing practice	Spin random N3, 3–5 min timer

N3 tips

- N3 is mostly a **reading-speed** test. Time yourself on every practice passage.
- Learn grammar in pairs that look similar (ようだ vs らしい, ため vs おかげで) — the exam loves to mix them.
- Your 1-minute speaking should now have a structure: わたしは～と思います。なぜなら～からです。

EXAM MONTH

The last 4 weeks

The JLPT is held in July and December in most countries. Registration closes months before — check your local test centre early.

4 weeks before

- ☐ Do one full mock test with a timer
- ☐ List your 20 weakest grammar points
- ☐ Stop learning new vocab — review only

2 weeks before

- ☐ Second full mock test
- ☐ Listening every day, 20 min
- ☐ Practise with an analogue watch

Test week

- ☐ Light review only, sleep 7+ hours
- ☐ Print your test voucher (受験票) + photo
- ☐ Pack: pencils, eraser, watch, ID
- ☐ Plan your route to the test centre

On the day

- ☐ Never leave an answer blank — guess
- ☐ Don't get stuck: move on, come back

Free resources that actually help

- **jlpt.jp** — official sample questions for every level (do these before any mock test)
- **NHK NEWS WEB EASY** — simple news with furigana and audio, perfect from late N4
- **Anki** — free spaced-repetition flashcards (desktop & Android)
- **Erin's Challenge / Marugoto (Japan Foundation)** — free video lessons with real conversations
- **jlptspin.com** — daily 1-minute speaking practice with English + Hindi meanings

Practise with me 🎡

I'm learning too. Every day I spin a word and speak for 1 minute — mistakes included. Post your own video, tag **@anurag.pov** with **#JLPTSpin**, and the best ones get reposted every week.
がんばりましょう！